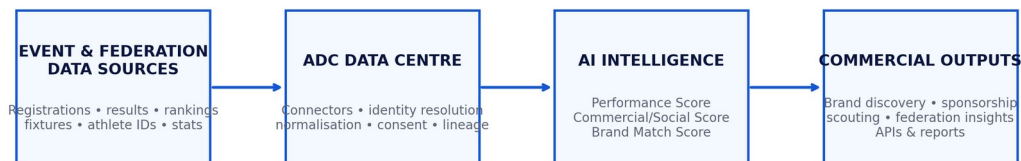


ATHLETE DATA COMPANY

Investor & Business Strategy Analysis

From fragmented event data to a persistent athlete intelligence network



Persistent Athlete Identity

One athlete → many events → one longitudinal record → commercially useful intelligence

Event Organizers

Digital athlete registry
Sponsor reporting
Post-event data asset

Federations / Leagues

Unified history
Scouting & development
Governance & reporting

Brands

Discover rising stars
Defensible fit scores
Campaign measurement

Athletes

Portable digital identity
Visibility
Commercial opportunity

Investor thesis: ADC is viable if it becomes the event-agnostic athlete data and commercial intelligence layer - not another all-in-one tournament management app.

Prepared August 2026 • Strategic assumptions are explicitly labelled

1. Executive Summary

ADC is addressing a real structural problem in sport: the same athlete participates across tournaments, leagues, academies and federations, while their identity, results, rankings, media signals and commercial history remain distributed across disconnected systems. The opportunity is to create a persistent athlete record that survives individual events and turns operational sports data into commercially useful intelligence.

Recommended category: “Athlete Data Infrastructure & Commercial Intelligence” — a neutral layer that plugs into event systems rather than replacing them.

Investor question	Assessment
Is the problem real?	Yes. Fragmented athlete data and disconnected event systems are common; federation platforms themselves market consolidation as a core need.
Is there demonstrated willingness to pay for sports data?	Yes. Genius Sports, Sportradar and Stats Perform operate large B2B data businesses with leagues, federations, media and brands.
Is ADC differentiated today?	Partially. The proposed combination is attractive, but KIBI Sports and SportsKeyz overlap materially. ADC needs a sharper interoperability + commercial-intelligence wedge.
Best beachhead?	Non-cricket / emerging sports events and federations where data exists but is fragmented and commercial analytics is weak.
Primary customer first?	Event organizers / federations as data-supply partners; brands become monetization customers after the athlete data pool has density.
Investor readiness today?	Conceptually promising; investability depends on data rights, repeatable event onboarding, demonstrable score quality and paid brand/federation pilots.

Recommended one-line pitch

ADC is the persistent athlete data layer across sports events - creating verified digital identities and AI-powered commercial intelligence that helps brands, federations and franchises discover the right athletes earlier.

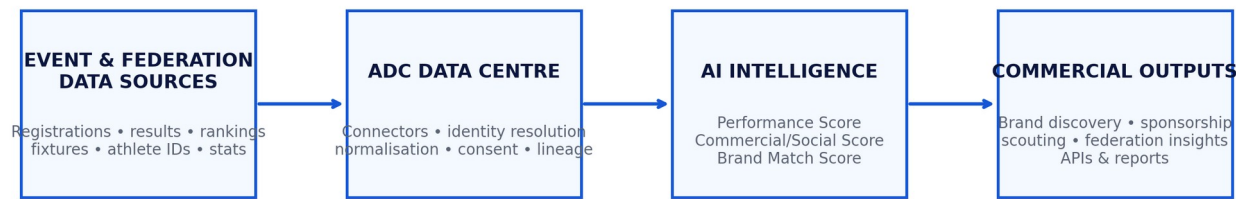
2. The Problem ADC Should Own

The fragmentation problem

- An athlete may appear in an academy database, district event portal, state federation system, national federation records, league software and social platforms - with no durable cross-system identity.
- Event websites are optimized for a specific event lifecycle: registration, fixtures, results and standings. Once the event ends, much of the data loses commercial context.
- Brands often evaluate athlete partnerships using fragmented proxies: follower count, agency recommendations, reputation and manual research rather than a consistent performance + audience + brand-fit model.
- Federations and franchises can see performance within their own systems but may lack longitudinal, cross-event visibility and commercially oriented athlete intelligence.

The key insight

The durable asset is not the event website. It is the athlete’s continuously improving data record. ADC should make that record portable, permissioned, verifiable and commercially useful.



Persistent Athlete Identity

One athlete → many events → one longitudinal record → commercially useful intelligence



3. Positioning: What ADC Is - and Is Not

ADC should be	ADC should NOT lead with
A sports data centre for athlete identity and intelligence	A generic tournament management platform
An API/connectors layer that works with existing event systems	A replacement for every federation/event website
A verified longitudinal athlete profile across events	A social profile with manually entered achievements
A commercial intelligence layer for sponsors and rights holders	An influencer marketplace based mainly on follower count
A score/explanation engine using structured, sport-specific data	A black-box AI score that brands cannot defend
A neutral data partner to organizers and federations	A rights-grabbing data reseller without clear consent/licensing

Suggested brand language

- “Sports Data Centre for the Athlete Economy.”
- “One athlete. Every event. One verified data identity.”
- “Turn event data into athlete intelligence and sponsorship opportunity.”
- “We do not replace your event platform; we make its athlete data more valuable.”

4. Why Now: Commercial Tailwinds

The opportunity is supported by both the scale of sports consumption and the increasing commercial value of data-led sponsorship. India’s sports economy reached ₹18,864 crore in 2025 according to WPP Media’s Sporting Nation report, including ₹7,943 crore of sports sponsorship spending. Deloitte and Google have separately projected a much broader Indian sports market of \$130 billion by 2030 and identified 655 million sports fans, underscoring the scale of the ecosystem. [S1][S2]

Signal	Implication for ADC
Sports sponsorship spend is large and still growing	Brands already have budgets; ADC does not need to create sponsorship demand from zero.
Digital sports consumption is rising	More athlete/fan signals can be captured and used in commercial scoring.
Non-cricket sports are becoming more investable	Fragmented emerging sports create a better wedge than cricket, where official data incumbents are strong.
Federations are digitizing operations	ADC can integrate into existing workflows instead of asking rights holders to rebuild them.
AI makes large-scale normalization and analysis cheaper	Entity matching, anomaly detection, summaries and score explanations become more scalable.

5. Product Strategy: Build the Data Layer First

Core platform modules

Module	What it does	Why it matters
1. Athlete Identity Graph	Resolves athlete records across events using identifiers, demographics, federation IDs and verified claims.	Creates the persistent record that competitors built around single events cannot easily reproduce.
2. Event Data Connectors	API, spreadsheet, webhook and partner integrations ingest registrations, results, rankings and event metadata.	Low-friction onboarding; ADC can work with heterogeneous event software.
3. Sport-specific Data Model	Normalizes metrics by sport, competition tier, age group, position/category and season.	Allows fair comparisons and reliable scoring.
4. Performance Engine	Generates sport-specific performance, consistency, progression and competition-strength indicators.	Turns raw results into understandable athlete intelligence.
5. Presence / Commercial Engine	Combines verified social, content, audience, media and community signals.	Measures commercial visibility without treating follower count as the only signal.
6. Brand Match Engine	Scores athlete-brand fit using audience, geography, values/category, performance trajectory, campaign objectives and price.	Directly monetizable B2B output.
7. Rights & Consent Layer	Stores consent, data source, permitted usage, minors/guardian status and audit history.	Essential for enterprise trust and data licensing.
8. Dashboards & API	Provides federation views, organizer reports, brand discovery and machine-readable data access.	Creates recurring software/data revenue.

Important AI design principle

Do not make the score “AI magic.” Use deterministic sport metrics + statistical/ML models for ranking, and use generative AI primarily for extraction, explanations, summaries and recommendations. Every score should be explainable and source-linked.

6. Event Organizer GTM: Position ADC as the Data Partner

Sports events already sell partnership categories such as title sponsor, apparel partner, hydration partner, payments partner, timing partner, broadcast partner and technology partner. ADC can create a new, non-conflicting property: “Official Athlete Data & Intelligence Partner” or “Official Athlete Insights Partner.”

What organizers give ADC

- Access to agreed event data feeds / exports
- Permission to create verified athlete records under defined terms
- Athlete consent collection embedded into registration
- Event branding rights for the data partnership
- Access to organizer/federation stakeholders for workflow integration

What ADC gives organizers

Organizer benefit	Practical deliverable	Business outcome
Unified athlete registry	Deduplicated participants and reusable digital profiles	Lower admin effort and cleaner future registrations
Post-event data asset	Results + participation + athlete history retained after event	Event value continues after closing ceremony
Sponsor intelligence	Sponsor-ready athlete shortlists and audience/fit views	New sponsorship inventory and better renewal conversations
Athlete visibility	Co-branded athlete profile pages and discovery	Improved athlete experience and organizer brand equity
Federation reporting	Participation, geography, progression, diversity and talent dashboards	Better governance, scouting and stakeholder reporting
Commercial attribution	Campaign/athlete engagement reporting for partners	More defensible sponsor ROI
Data interoperability	Exports/APIs to federation or league systems	Organizer avoids another data silo
Revenue share	Commission on sponsorship facilitated through ADC	Potential new non-ticket revenue stream

Pilot offer that is hard to refuse

“ADC will digitize and unify your athlete dataset, create verified athlete profiles, deliver an organizer insights dashboard and a sponsor-ready rising-star report for one event. Minimal integration; commercial upside shared.”

7. Recommended Go-To-Market

Recommended GTM: event-led data acquisition → intelligence → recurring B2B revenue



Beachhead selection criteria

Prioritize	Avoid initially
Regional/national events with 300–5,000 athletes	Top-tier properties with exclusive official-data contracts
Sports with recurring events and measurable performance	One-off exhibition events with little structured athlete data
Organizers using spreadsheets/basic portals or willing to export data	Organizations demanding full system replacement before pilot
Sports with sponsorship upside but weak data infrastructure	Sports where ADC cannot legally access/use data
Events that can collect athlete consent at registration	Datasets involving minors without guardian/rights workflows

Suggested first sports

Start with 2–3 sports where event density is high, metrics are structured, and incumbent official-data rights are less entrenched. A reasonable India wedge could be badminton, athletics, volleyball/kabaddi or racquet events outside the largest professional properties. Tennis is a useful benchmark because HitCourt shows federation appetite for digitized circuits, but ADC should integrate rather than rebuild tournament administration. [S3]

Land-and-expand motion

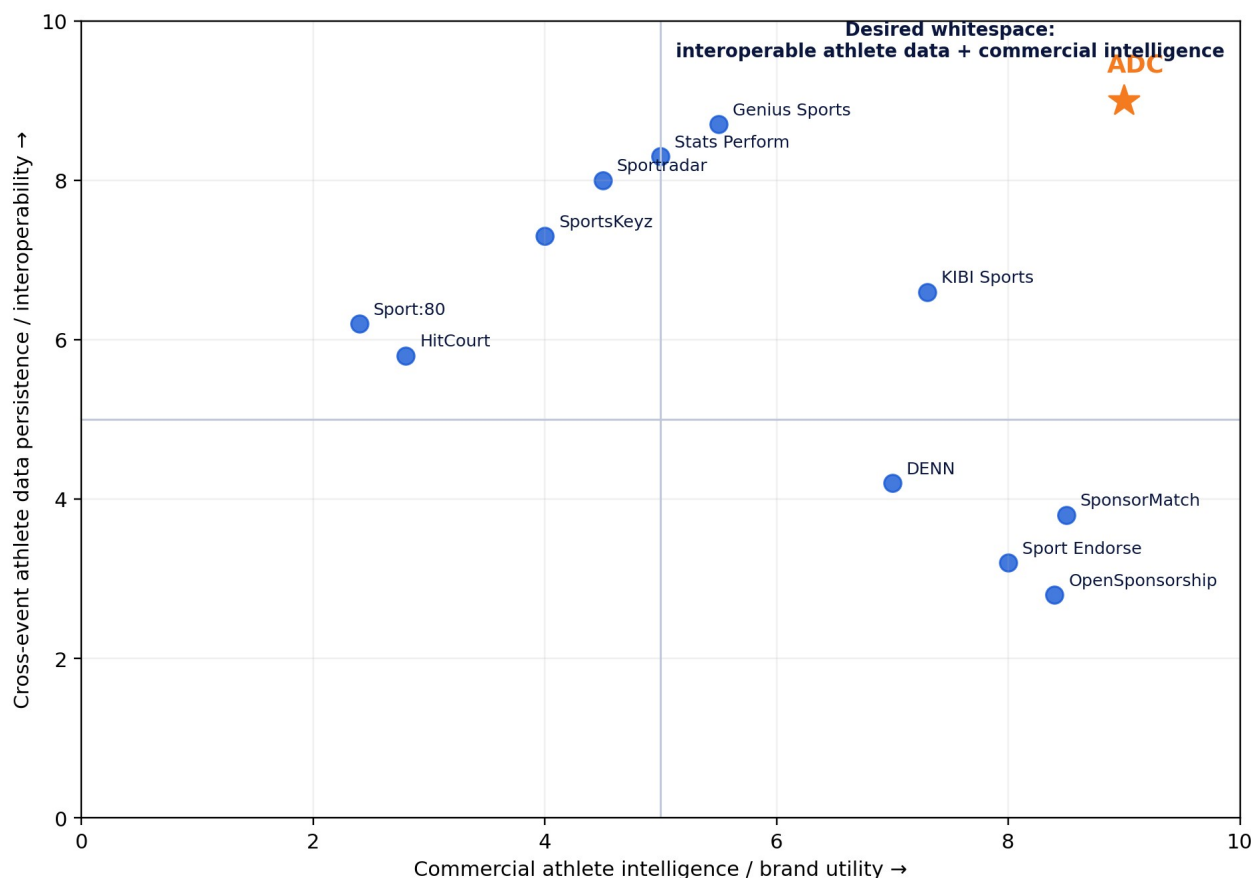
- Land with a single-event data partnership.
- Expand to the organizer’s full annual calendar.
- Convert the organizer/federation to an annual data platform contract.
- Use pooled athlete density to sell brand intelligence subscriptions.
- Facilitate sponsorships and take a transaction/commission share.
- Offer standardized APIs/benchmark data to franchises, scouts and approved third parties.

8. Core User Groups & Jobs-to-be-Done

User	Job-to-be-done	ADC product	Primary KPI
Brands / agencies	Find rising athletes earlier and justify sponsorship spend	Discovery, brand-match scores, audience/performance insights, campaign reporting	Search→shortlist, shortlist→deal, campaign ROI, repeat spend
Federations / leagues	Maintain trusted athlete history and identify development patterns	Unified profiles, performance dashboards, cohort/region analytics, API	Profile completeness, data quality, scouting usage, annual renewal
Franchises / scouts	Find athletes across events with verified progression	Cross-event search, performance trend, competition strength	Athletes discovered, scouting conversion, time saved
Event organizers	Digitize data, add athlete value, monetize sponsor relationships	Event data hub, athlete pages, sponsor report	Registration reuse, sponsor revenue, organizer renewal
Athletes	Build a portable identity and become discoverable	Verified profile, history, visibility, sponsorship readiness	Claim rate, profile completion, opportunities received

9. Competitive Landscape - Investor View

ADC is not entering a blank market. Several categories already solve pieces of the problem, and some newer Indian platforms overlap significantly. The opportunity is therefore not “no competitors”; it is a specific whitespace between official event data, persistent athlete identity and commercial intelligence.



Category / player	Strength	Gap relative to ADC thesis	Threat
Genius Sports	Official data, AI tracking, league/federation technology, fan activation; 400+ official sports partners on its data API pages.	Primarily top-tier rights/data ecosystems; ADC can focus emerging-event athlete identity and brand intelligence.	High globally
Sportradar	Deep sports data, APIs, integrity, media/marketing and federation relationships.	Strong on official data and fan/commercial services; less about open athlete identity across grassroots events.	High globally
Stats Perform / Opta	Trusted data collection, AI and league/federation fan engagement.	Premium professional sports focus; ADC can target fragmented lower tiers and commercial identity.	High globally
HitCourt	Strong federation/tournament operating layer for tennis; profiles, rankings, analytics.	Sport-specific; not positioned primarily as cross-sport commercial athlete intelligence.	Partner/adjacent
Sport:80 / federation SaaS	Membership, federation operations, events and governance.	Operational system of record rather than brand/athlete commercial intelligence network.	Adjacent
SportsKeyz (India)	Digital sports identity, federation workflows, verified history, open infrastructure.	Very close to ADC identity/data thesis; ADC must differentiate via commercial intelligence and event-agnostic connectors.	High in India
KIBI Sports (India)	90K+ athletes, events, sponsorship, AI matching, 257+ brand partners claimed.	Substantial overlap across athlete, event and sponsorship layers.	Very high in India
OpenSponsorship / Sport Endorse	Large athlete-brand marketplaces and campaign workflows.	Strong commercial marketplace, but less focused on event-derived longitudinal performance identity.	High on brand side
SponsorMatch / DENN	AI sponsorship matching / visibility scoring.	Close on scoring; ADC's moat must be official/verified event data depth and	Medium-high

		cross-event identity.	
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Most important competitor conclusion

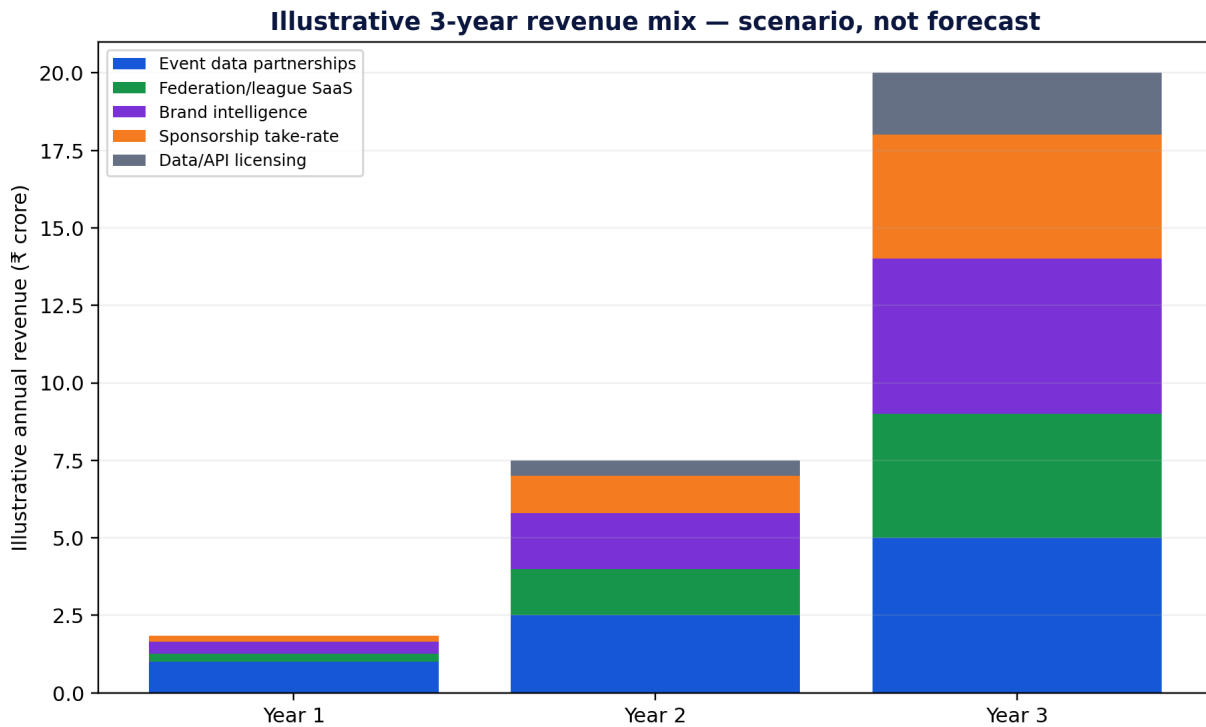
KIBI and SportsKeyz mean ADC cannot win on “one sports platform for everyone.” ADC needs a narrower, stronger claim: interoperability across event systems + persistent athlete identity + explainable commercial intelligence for rights holders and brands.

10. Business Model & Pricing Architecture

The best model is B2B2C: organizers/federations supply permissioned athlete/event data, while brands and rights holders pay for intelligence and commercial outcomes. Athlete profiles can remain free to maximize network density.

Revenue stream	Buyer	Recommended model (illustrative)	Why it works
Event Data Partner	Organizer	₹2–10L per regional event; larger events custom	Immediate services/software revenue and data acquisition.
Federation / League SaaS	Federation/league	₹10–50L+ annual contract based on athlete/event volume	Recurring revenue and defensible data relationships.
Brand Intelligence SaaS	Brands/agencies	₹3–15L annual mid-market; enterprise custom	High-margin discovery, scoring and reporting.
Sponsorship Facilitation	Brand / athlete / organizer	10–20% of facilitated commercial value	Aligns ADC revenue with measurable outcomes.
Data/API Licensing	Approved partners	₹5–25L+ annual depending on scope/rights	Monetizes normalized data without requiring UI usage.
White-label Insights	Leagues/franchises	Project or annual fee	Lets rights holders offer branded athlete intelligence.

Pricing above is a recommended starting architecture, not observed market pricing. It should be validated through 10–20 customer interviews and paid pilots.



11. Investor Viability & Unit Economics Logic

Investor lens	What good looks like	ADC proof required
Data acquisition cost	Data comes through repeatable integrations, not manual analyst work per athlete	Time/cost to onboard an event falls each quarter
Gross margin	Software/data subscriptions grow faster than managed services	>65–70% blended gross margin after productization
Retention	Federations/brands renew because longitudinal data gets more valuable over time	Annual renewal and multi-event expansion
Network effect	Each event adds athletes/history that improve discovery for future buyers	% of athletes with multi-event records
Monetization density	Brand revenue per 1,000 verified athletes rises as coverage improves	Brand ARR / 1,000 active profiles
Defensibility	Rights, identity graph, normalized longitudinal data and benchmark models compound	Exclusive/long-term data relationships + unique historical coverage
Sales efficiency	Event/federation relationships produce multiple downstream brand opportunities	CAC payback and event–brand cross-sell

My investor rating if executed as recommended

Dimension	Today (concept)	With 12-month proof
Problem strength	8/10	9/10
Differentiation	6/10	9/10 if interoperability wedge is proven
Revenue clarity	6/10	9/10 with paid event + brand contracts
Data moat	5/10	9/10 with multi-event identity graph
GTM clarity	7/10	9/10 after repeatable event partner motion
Overall investability	6.5/10	8.5–9/10

12. Data & AI Moat: What Must Be Proprietary

Three layers of data

Layer	Examples	Strategic value
Core athlete data	Identity, sport, DOB/age band, geography, team/academy, federation IDs	Entity resolution and verified profile
Performance data	Results, rank, competition tier, opponent quality, consistency, progression, selection	Athlete quality and trajectory
Commercial/presence data	Social growth, engagement quality, content, audience geography, media mentions, campaign history	Sponsor fit and pricing power

Score architecture

- Performance Score: sport-specific; normalize by age/category, tournament tier, recency and consistency.
- Growth Potential Score: trend-based; should not simply reward current elite athletes.
- Commercial Presence Score: audience quality, content consistency, fan interest, sentiment/brand safety and reach.
- Brand Match Score: objective-specific; category fit, geography, audience, athlete values, performance trajectory, price/value and campaign format.
- Confidence Score: every output should show data completeness and confidence so brands understand uncertainty.

The moat is not the score formula alone. The moat is the permissioned longitudinal dataset + identity resolution + outcome history that continuously improves the model.

13. Critical Risks & How to De-risk Them

Risk	Why it matters	Mitigation
Data rights / ownership	Event results may be controlled by organizers/federations or licensed to official-data partners.	Contract explicit rights for storage, enrichment, profile creation, commercial analytics and API use.
Athlete consent & privacy	Profiles can include personal/social data; minors require special care.	Consent-by-purpose, guardian consent for minors, deletion/export workflows, data minimization and DPDP/GDPR controls.
Identity errors	Same-name athletes or inconsistent IDs can corrupt histories.	Confidence-based entity resolution + human verification for ambiguous matches.
Score bias / explainability	Brands/federations may reject opaque or unfair rankings.	Feature transparency, confidence labels, sport-specific validation and appeal/correction workflows.
Cold-start problem	Without data density, brand intelligence is weak.	Event partnerships first; do not launch broad marketplace before supply quality.
Incumbent overlap	KIBI/SportsKeyz can move into the same space.	Integrate with systems, own cross-event interoperability, commercial outcomes and niche data depth.
Long enterprise sales cycles	Federations can be slow and political.	Use event operators/academies as faster entry; build reference cases before federation-wide procurement.
Services trap	Manual data cleaning can destroy margins.	Standard connectors, schemas and onboarding playbooks; track onboarding hours/event as a core KPI.

14. 12-Month Execution Blueprint

Quarter	Product	GTM	Proof target
Q1	Athlete identity schema, CSV/API ingestion, profile MVP, consent layer	5–10 event pilots across 2 sports	5K+ verified profiles; <2 days integration per repeatable format
Q2	Performance score v1, organizer dashboard, brand search prototype	20+ events; 5 brand design partners	First paid event contracts; 3 brand pilots; multi-event athlete records
Q3	Brand Match Score, campaign reporting, federation export/API	2–3 federation/league pilots; 10–15 paying brands	Paid brand ARR; organizer renewal; sponsorship value facilitated
Q4	Connector library, benchmarking, self-serve discovery, governance tooling	50+ events; 2 annual federation deals; multi-city expansion	₹1–2Cr+ annualized contracted revenue path; evidence of >60% software/data gross margin

North-star metrics

- Verified athletes with persistent IDs
- % athletes with data from 2+ independent events
- Event/federation renewal rate
- Data completeness and identity-match accuracy
- Brand search → shortlist → contact → deal conversion
- Sponsorship value enabled and ADC take-rate
- Brand recurring revenue and campaign repeat rate
- Integration effort per event / cost per verified athlete

15. What I Would Do - and What I Would Avoid

Do	Avoid
Sell “Official Athlete Data & Intelligence Partner” to events	Pitching a huge consumer app before B2B data supply is established
Integrate with existing tournament software	Rebuilding registration, scoring and tournament tools for every

	sport
Make athlete profiles free and portable	Charging athletes before they receive real commercial value
Monetize brands/federations for intelligence and outcomes	Depending on ads or fan monetization as the first revenue model
Use event/federation data as the verification backbone	Building scores mostly from self-reported profile data
Create explainable, sport-specific scores	Using one universal black-box score across all sports
Start in underserved sports and tiers	Taking on Genius/Sportradar/Stats Perform in elite official live data on day one

16. Sample Event Organizer Partnership Pitch

“Your event already creates valuable athlete data. ADC helps you retain and monetize that value after the event.”

ADC partners with sports events as an Athlete Data & Intelligence Partner. We ingest your registration and results data, create verified athlete identities, connect repeat participants across events, and generate organizer, federation and sponsor insights. You retain your event workflow; ADC adds the longitudinal data and commercial layer.

Before ADC	With ADC
Event data ends in event portal/spreadsheets	Persistent athlete records continue across future events
Sponsors see inventory and generic reach	Sponsors receive athlete-level fit and measurable activation insights
Athletes repeatedly rebuild profiles	Athletes reuse a verified digital sports identity
Organizer reports basic participation/results	Organizer gets talent, geography, progression and commercial dashboards
No direct monetization of athlete intelligence	New sponsorship packages and revenue-share opportunities

17. Strategic Conclusion

The ADC thesis makes sense, but the investable version is narrower than “a unified sports ecosystem.” The strongest wedge is to become the interoperable athlete data and commercial intelligence layer across events. Event partnerships solve the cold-start problem because they provide verified data at source; persistent athlete identity creates compounding value; and brands/federations create high-value B2B monetization.

The biggest strategic risk is competitive overlap. KIBI Sports already markets athlete/event/sponsorship infrastructure and AI matching, while SportsKeyz is explicitly building a verified digital identity infrastructure for Indian sport. ADC therefore needs to prove a differentiated architecture and GTM: work with existing platforms, normalize data across them, and become the commercial intelligence layer rather than another closed operating system. [S4][S5]

The milestone that changes ADC from “interesting idea” to “venture-backable company”: 25–50 event data partnerships + 20K–50K verified multi-event athlete records + 10+ paying brands + 2–3 annual federation/league contracts + measurable sponsorship outcomes.

18. Research Sources & Benchmarks

[S1] WPP Media - Sporting Nation 2025 — India sports economy ₹18,864 crore in 2025; sponsorship ₹7,943 crore.
<https://www.wppmedia.com/news/sporting-nation-india-sports-sponsorship-report-2025>

[S2] Deloitte + Google - Think Sports — \$130B India sports market projection by 2030; 655M sports fans.
<https://www.deloitte.com/in/en/about/press-room/indias-sports-market-set-to-soar-to-reach-130-bn-by-2030-deloitte-n-google.html>

[S3] HitCourt — Federation tournament operations, rankings, player data and analytics; benchmark for event/federation digitization.
<https://www.hitcourt.com/>

[S4] KIBI Sports — Claims 90K+ athletes, event operations, sponsorship connections, brand partners and AI matchmaker.
<https://www.kibisports.com/>

[S5] SportsKeyz — Indian digital sports identity infrastructure; federation/event management and verified performance history.
<https://www.sportskeyz.com/en>

[S6] Genius Sports — Official sports data, AI, performance, fan activation and brand ecosystem.
<https://www.geniussports.com/>

[S7] Genius Sports - Official Data API — 400+ official sports partners; official real-time/historical data use cases.
<https://www.geniussports.com/engage/official-sports-data-api/>

[S8] Sportradar — Data/technology for teams, leagues, federations, media and marketing.
<https://sportradar.com/>

[S9] Stats Perform — Opta data, AI and fan/commercial growth services for leagues/federations.
<https://www.statsperform.com/industries/teams-and-federations/>

[S10] OpenSponsorship — Athlete/team/influencer sponsorship marketplace and brand discovery.
<https://opensponsorship.com/sports-sponsorship>

[S11] Sport Endorse — Verified athlete discovery and sponsorship management for brands/agencies.
<https://www.sportendorse.com/>

[S12] SponsorMatch — AI-powered matching of brands with clubs, associations, events and athletes.
<https://www.sponsormatch.ai/>

[S13] DENN — Visibility scoring and athlete discovery for brand sponsorship.
<https://www.dennsports.com/brands>

[S14] KPMG India - Sportlight — India sports-tech and sports industry context; sponsorship and non-cricket growth.
<https://kpmg.com/in/en/insights/2025/09/sportlight-the-business-of-sports-in-india.html>

Methodology note

Competitor features and scale figures are taken from the companies' own current websites and should be treated as vendor claims unless independently audited. Revenue scenarios and suggested pricing in this report are strategic hypotheses for validation, not forecasts or third-party benchmarks. The report intentionally distinguishes observed market evidence from recommended ADC strategy.